The extent to which she used the aforementioned powers, during her tenures as DCP (West) and DCP (North), was apparent from the crowds of 250–300 people who would attend the 'court session' at her office daily from 2 p.m. to 5 p.m. Such people would gather in connection with a wide range of issues, such as fixing hearings for jailable offences, seeking bail and asking for general counselling. Her staff members would accept the applications from the people and prepare the required reports for Kiran to study. There never was any need for a lawyer. It was this single-minded and determined performance of her duties that may have antagonized the lawyers of the Tees Hazari courts. Keeping litigation going to the extent possible apparently constituted some of the lawyers' 'bread and butter'. Kiran had, unwittingly, but nevertheless rudely, snatched this 'right' from the lawyers. However, she was to realize the extent of their antagonism only later, i.e., when she found herself caught up in the imbroglio resulting due to the lawyers' agitation, which paralysed the legal machinery all over the country (for details see Chapter 11).

In the 'social justice system' adopted by Kiran, the accused would be 'show caused' with his or her specific offence(s) and then be asked to fetch his parents or close relatives or even neighbours to her 'court'. These people were given the responsibility of ensuring that the culprit desisted from his or her criminal ways or else he or she would no longer be able to live with them because he or she would be externed for a year or two. Such a situation put the onus on the culprit who felt that he or she now owed something to the family and neighbourhood for allowing him or her to stay with them, and this also brought families closer. Somehow, they could not get around to breaking the faith reposed in them by Kiran. Incidentally, the beat constable too was keeping up his home visits.

Kiran has that special something about her that she probably derives from her honesty, hard work, goodwill and compassion. The fluctuating graph of arrests relating to when she was in charge and when she was not speaks volumes.

These sittings in 'court' as DCP (North) were different from those as DCP (West) in that here every second offender was a drug addict. The parents would reveal that despite all the pressure that they could exert, even going so far as to tie up their sons, they could not get them out of the habit.

'I was shocked,' exclaims Kiran. 'Here I was trying to act the policewoman when what these youngsters actually needed was pharmacological and community management!'

The enormity of the situation struck her when her academic pursuits told her that as a matter of fact only 4 per cent of such cases, including mother and wife beating, were reported to the police! And such was the state of affairs when 94 per cent of the families were affected by domestic violence.

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In 1986 there was *only one* centre in Delhi for the treatment of drug abusers and that was Ashiana (meaning nest), established by the NDMC (New Delhi Municipal Corporation). Kiran was convinced that the menace of drug abuse could be controlled only if more centres were established where the abuser would have to stay away from his or her family and from accessibility to drugs. Here, he or she would get a package for therapeutic treatment. She began looking for such a place and she did not have to look far. There it was in front of her: her own police station. There and then the concept of 'Navjyoti' was born, i.e., in June 1986. She appealed to the community at large for help and, as always, it was forthcoming and in abundance. Beds, blankets, *durries* (rugs), televisions, fans, doctors, yoga teachers and medicines came in a flood. Food usually came from the patients' homes or from nearby hotels. At the launch, Ved Marwah and Rajendra Mohan were present and were very supportive of the rehabilitation work. This social work initiated by Kiran finally consolidated itself into a registered foundation called Navjyoti Delhi Police Foundation for Correction, Deaddiction and